



Andalusite

△ **Blocky** andalusite crystals grouped in a matrix

Crystals of andalusite are pleochroic, meaning they appear to be different colours when viewed from different angles. Andalusite is named after Andalusia, the Spanish region where it was first discovered. It is an aluminium silicate, closely related to both silimanite and kyanite, with which it shares the same chemical composition, but it has a different crystal structure. A strikingly beautiful but relatively lesser-known gem type, andalusite is most often opaque or translucent, with transparent specimens being extremely rare.

Specification

Chemical name Aluminium silicate | **Formula** $\text{Al}_2(\text{SiO}_4)\text{O}$
Colours Pink, brown, white, grey, violet, yellow, green, blue
Structure Orthorhombic | **Hardness** 7.5 | **SG** 3–3.2
RI 1.63–1.64 | **Lustre** Vitreous | **Streak** White
Locations Belgium, Australia, Russia, Germany, USA

Four chiasolite crystals



Cross-section | Rough | These andalusite crystals are of the variety chiasolite, with a cross-shaped cluster of elongated and tapered crystals.

Polished cross-sections



Smooth cabochons | Cut | Chiasolite is often tumble-polished into rounded gems. These fine examples highlight the typical cross-shaped twinning.

Yellow-brown colours



Octagonal step cut | Cut | This fine octagonal, step cut gem presents a pleasing blend of yellow-tinted brown, highlighted by its bold cut.

Facets show the different colours



Faceted oval | Cut | This yellow-tinted andalusite gemstone has an oval step cut, emphasizing the exceptional clarity and brilliance of the stone.

Andalusite slab | Rough | This specimen is another example of chiasolite – andalusite that forms cross-shaped patterns.



Single crystal

Dark graphite impurities

Andalusite
is known
as the
“seeing
stone”

Faceted oval stone



Ring with andalusite | Set | This distinctively asymmetrical ring features an oval-cut andalusite gemstone surrounded by a swirl of diamonds.